had to prove citizenship. Still, any future biographer will run the risk of thinking I did not become a citizen till 1949 if he is careless with the documentary evidence.

Even after all the data had been gone into at the appropriate government office, it was not enough. They asked to see my mother. On March 30, my mother and I went to the office for the purpose. My mother got dressed to the brim, including a fetching black hat with a veil suspended from it and dangling in front of her face.

At the subway station, while waiting for the train, she walked over to a peanut vending machine (which they had at the stations in those days) and put in a penny (which was all they asked for in those days). Out came a penny's worth of peanuts, which she tossed dexterously toward her mouth. The next thing I saw was my mother righting away in front of her face as though she were defending herself from a swarm of bees. I went rushing over, but it turned out that in tossing the peanuts into her mouth, she had forgotten she was wearing a veil.

At the offices, she was closeted with the official privately, and when I entered finally and asked what it was all about, he wouldn't tell me. After we left, I asked my mother, and she said that because of the inadequacy of the documentation of her marriage, she had to testify that I was not of illegitimate birth.

I laughed, not so much over the suspicion, but over the embarrassment of the official, who could not bring himself to mention it to

me (for fear I suppose, that I would go into a rage and knock him down).

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I then took my mother home and went on to Elizabeth, for I had finished "—And Now You Don't" the day before, at last. While there we discussed another positronic robot story, to be called 'The Evitable Conflict."

On March 31, Campbell took "—And Now You Don't," and a check for $1,000 came on April 5. It was the most I had ever gotten for a single piece of writing, and was, in fact, the largest check I had ever seen.

The story was, however, the last of the Foundation series, which I had been working on now, on and off, for 7V2 years and which included eight stories that had earned me a total of just over $3,600.